Ford Motor Company

A. R. O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs
Ford Customer Service Division

Ford Motor Company
P.O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121

TO:

SUBJECT: Safety Recall 01S17 - Certain 2000 Model Year F-650 and F-750 Trucks and F7000/F8000 Trucks equipped with size 24 DL TRW Ball Sockets - Drag Link Inspection

AFFECTED VEHICLES

All affected vehicles were equipped with size 24 DL TRW tie rod and drag link ball sockets:

- Certain 2000 MY F7000 and F8000 trucks built from 7/30/99 through 12/31/99 at Valencia Assembly Plant in Venezuela
- Certain 2000 MY F-650 and F-750 trucks built from 7/25/99 through 12/31/99 at Cuautitlan Assembly Plant in Cuautitlan, Mexico
- Certain vehicles serviced with suspect 24DL TRW ball sockets (See Attachment I and II)

REASON FOR RECALL

The affected vehicles were built with drag link assemblies that use size 24-DL ball stud sockets made by TRW. These sockets may not have proper case depth and hardness that may lead to premature wear. In some cases, the ball stud may separate from the socket, which could potentially result in a reduction or loss of steering control.

SERVICE ACTION

Dealers are to inspect Drag links and in a small number of cases, Tie Rod assemblies, (See Attachments II & III for further direction).

1. Inspect the date code on the drag link assembly on each of the affected vehicles. If the drag link falls into the affected build period, it will be replaced. For a small number of units, the tie rod ends will also be inspected and, if necessary, replaced.
2. Inspect dealer stock and purge affected service parts.
3. Also, identify any vehicles serviced by your dealership with suspect parts and provide customers with a copy of the owner letter.

NOTE: Tie rod ends are to be replaced in pairs. (See Attachment III)

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information and Refund Codes
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Customer Notification Letter

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:.....1-800-423-8851
Other Program Questions:.....1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

Safety Recall 01S17
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Administrative Information

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall. Please note that some vehicles serviced with the suspect parts may have been built outside the affected vehicle date range listed on the first page of this bulletin. These vehicle VINs known to Ford Motor Company are identified in OASIS.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $5,000 per vehicle.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer Recall/ONP Involved Unit Listings available on QCDealer.com. Also, correct other affected vehicles identified in OASIS which are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Our records indicate that some vehicles were serviced with the affected service parts. We have included these vehicles on the affected owner list and in OASIS.

Please check your records according to the directions in Attachment II. If you replaced any of the suspect 24DL tie rod ends or drag link assemblies between 7/25/99 and the date of this letter, please contact the owner. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- Cannot be contacted.
- Does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII Manual for claims preparation and submission information.

OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid repairs made before the date of the Owner Letter (or after the date of the Owner Letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer). Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

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RENTAL CARS

Rental vehicles are not approved for this program.

PARTS RETENTION

Follow the provisions of the Warranty and Policy Manual for "Parts Retention and Return Procedures".

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LABOR ALLOWANCES

2000 Model Year F650/750 and F7000/F8000 Trucks (includes time for setting toe)

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Inspect drag link (and inspect tie-rod ends for a small number of vehicles)	01S17A	0.2 Hours
Inspect drag link (and inspect tie-rod ends for a small number of vehicles), replace drag link	01S17B	0.7 Hours
Inspect drag link (and inspect tie-rod ends for a small number of vehicles), replace both tie rod ends	01S17C	1.5 Hours
Inspect drag link (and inspect tie-rod ends for a small number of vehicles), replace drag link and both tie rod ends	01S17D	1.7 Hours
Administration Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hour

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information

Parts will not be direct shipped for this program. Order your part requirements through normal order processing channels as noted below:

Stock Orders	Effective immediately	Normal order process
Interim Orders	Effective immediately	Normal order process
Emergency Orders	31 days after launch	Normal order process
Emergency Orders	First 30 Days	800-325-5621

NOTE: The populations of the vehicles listed in OASIS used in production are:

- **F81Z-3304-DE 754 vehicles nationally**
- **YC3Z-3304-AA 258 vehicles nationally**

Follow inspection and replacement procedure for drag link in Attachment III.

Part Number	Description	Quantity
F81Z-3304-DE	Rod Assembly- Drag Link (9,000 lb. Axle)	1 per vehicle
YC3Z-3304-AA	Rod Assembly- Drag Link (10,000, 16K Axle)	1 per vehicle

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IDENTIFICATION OF VEHICLES SERVICED WITH SUSPECT PARTS

Vehicles known to Ford Motor Company that were serviced with suspect components have been included in OASIS. If your records indicate that any vehicles received suspect service parts (identified in the chart below) between July 25, 1999 and the date of this bulletin, dealers should contact the owner and arrange an inspection. Please note that this search of your parts sales records applies to any vehicle that may have received these parts. Please contact the Special Service Support Center (1-800-325-5621), if you are aware of any such vehicles.

Suspect Drag Link and Tie Rod Assemblies		
F4HZ-3304-A	**F5HZ-3304-YA**	**F81Z-3304-DE**
F5HZ-3304-ABA	E4HZ-3280-D	EOHZ-3304-D
F3HZ-3A131-B	F5HZ-3304-AJA	F5HZ-3304-VA
F5HZ-3304-ZA	F5HZ-3A131-AA	F6HZ-3A131-AA
F8HZ-3280-CA	F8HZ-3280-AA	F3HZ-3A130-B

DOR/COR NUMBER

DOR/COR Number 50239 identifies parts ordered for this campaign through the Special Service Support Center (1-800-325-5621).

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to:

- DOES II
- Updated Price Book

PARTS PURGE

NOTE: Dealers must use claim reason code "GC" and reference program 01S17 in the comments box on the claim form.

Inspect dealer stock and purge all suspect tie rod ends and drag link assemblies identified in the chart above that have the following date codes: Date Codes (See Attachment III for instructions on how to read date codes)

- 9G2
- 9G3

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

Ford Motor Company

Ford Motor Company
P.O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121

01S17

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

This notice is sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has decided that a defect which relates to motor vehicle safety exists in certain 2000 model year F-650 and F-750 trucks equipped with size 24 DL TRW drag link ball sockets. Additionally, a small number of 1980 through 2000 model year medium and heavy trucks may have had a service part installed that may contain a defective size 24DL TRW ball socket.

We apologize for this situation and want to assure you that with your assistance we will correct this condition. Our commitment, together with Ford dealers, is to provide you with the highest level of service and support possible.

What the issue is...

Certain vehicles were built or serviced with drag link and tie rod assemblies that may prematurely wear, potentially resulting in a separation of the ball stud from the socket and a reduction or loss of steering control.

What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do...

***Ford Motor Company* will repair your vehicle free of charge (parts and labor).** The dealer will inspect the date code on the drag link assembly. If the drag link fails the inspection, the drag link assembly will be replaced. For a small number of vehicles, the tie rod ends will also be inspected and, if necessary, replaced. Dealers currently have repair instructions and parts ordering information.

What we are asking you to do...

Contact your dealer right away to schedule a service appointment. Your dealer will need to inspect your vehicle to determine if parts are required. If parts are required, they may need to be ordered before repairs can be completed.

If you've already paid for this service...

If you have already paid to have this service performed after 7/25/99 but prior to the date of this letter, Ford Motor Company will provide you a full refund. *Please provide your original receipt to your Ford dealer for refund processing.*

If you've changed address or sold the vehicle...

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us if you have changed address or sold the vehicle.

If you have concerns...

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact the Ford Motor Company North American Customer Relationship Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

Call:	1-866-436-7332
Office Hours:	8am - 8pm (Monday-Friday) ET 9am - 6pm (Saturday) ET

Or contact us through the Internet at: www.ownerconnection.com

You may also send a complaint to the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street, S.W., Washington, D.C. 20590, or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline at 1-888-327-4236 or 1-800-424-9393.

Quality Care service is there for you all year round.

QualityCare™ at your service

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading Consumer Company for automotive products and services. Again, we are sorry for the inconvenience. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs